

LEARN CONTEMPORARY CABLES



**MACHINE KNIT
WITH KNIT-1**

Contemporary Cables



Contemporary Cables.

This course includes:

- ❖ Basic cabling, 2, 3 and bigger st cables and plaits.
- ❖ Travelling cables and plaits.
- ❖ Cables with purl sts.
- ❖ Double cable, oxo cable, pointelle cable, giant cable.
- ❖ Very open holding cam cable.
- ❖ Appliqué cables.
- ❖ How to change the direction of cables with holding cam corners.
- ❖ Yoking technique, re-hanging on machine.
- ❖ Using cable in a seam.
- ❖ Joining fabrics with cables, macramé examples.

15 Fully explained techniques.

49 design/ swatch examples.

Explains historical context and shows examples of Arans and how to translate them into contemporary fashion.

To knit cables you will need two 3 prong tools, two 2 prongs and two 6 prong tools.

“It is incredibly rewarding realising how many skills I have obtained, and stimulating to see it is barely the tip of the iceberg!” - Jillian, California.



Inspiration.



These are examples of traditional Aran knitting from the eponymous islands off the coast of Ireland. They are the original cable knits and have a very beautiful sculptural effect.



The patterns depict images and symbols of everyday life, there are cables – fishing ropes and knots, the diamond shapes of fishing nets, and the zigzag of lightning and marriage lines.

- ❖ You could choose this sculptural element to exploit, in order to make your cables contemporary, or simply make beautiful patterns in original placements and colours.

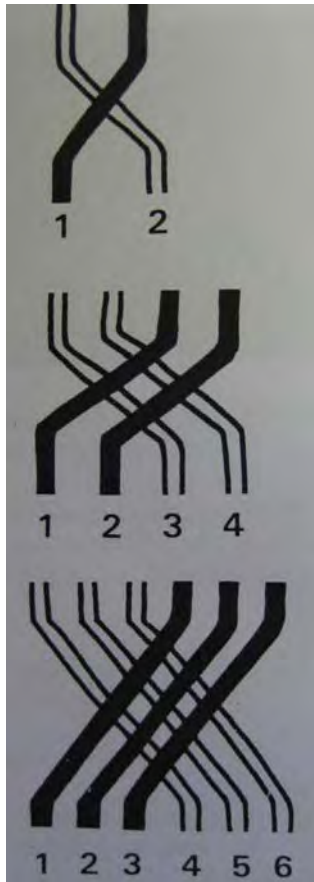


For reference and to help you make your own cable patterns, take a look at some knots and try tying some yourself; Celtic, fishing and Chinese knots are particularly useful.



Start with a 2 stitch cable.

A cable is two groups of stitches that cross each other. They can be made by crossing 1,2 or 3 sts from left to right or right to left.



Cables can be tight to knit as you are crossing stitches and asking the yarn to stretch. You will need a ladder either side of your cable, the ladder has more stretch if you knit it then 'ladder' down. Make sure this stitch is secure by transferring it first.

- Transfer 1 stitch either side of a group of four needles, keep empty needles in action and knit a few rows.
- Using the 2 prong tool take the left hand 2 st of the group of 4 off the needles.



- Move the tool to the left and hold in your left hand.



- Use the other 2 prong tool, in your right hand, transfer the right hand 2st. to the left hand needles.
- Put the remaining sts. on the right hand needles.



- Pull the needles forward to position D or E. -This makes it easier to knit!
- Knit 6 rows and repeat.



This forms a purl stitch on the right side.

- Drop the stitches that you transferred earlier- beside the cable. Knit back up, with latch tool, on the wrong side.



3 stitch Cable.



Use the three prong tool and start with a group of 6st.

Look at your group of 6 needles count from left to right 1,2,3,4,5,6

To make a cable you always repeat the direction you cross the sts – 1,2,3 over 4,5,6 for example.

- See what happens when you reverse the direction, so 1,2,3 under 4,5,6, then 4,5,6 under 1,2,3.



- You can vary the amount of rows in between crossing for a more interesting cable.



Travelling cables.



Now you have practised the two and three stitch cable- and only by practising do you get faster- now we will make your cables move in a direction.

So you will be able to knit patterns that have diamonds or diagonal lines in them or start cabling at each edge of your swatch and bring the cables to meet in the centre.

Your cables can travel in any direction across your knit, the angle depends on how many rows you put in between transferring stitches.

To get a definite diagonal cable you must move the cable and some surrounding stitches to keep it neat.

Follow my instructions;

- Start 10sts from the left edge of your fabric.
 - Take the 3 prong tool and fashion 3sts. 1 st. to the right.
 - Push empty needle back into NWP.
 - Knit 2 rows.
- 
- * Fashion the same 3 sts 1 more st. to the right, push empty needle back to NWP.
 - The 6st. to the left of the non- working needles are your cable group.





- Transfer these 6sts. 1 st. to the right.
- The empty needles either side of your 6st. should be pushed to NWP and will ladder.
- Knit 2 rows.
- Repeat from * 1st to the right ..
- **BUT** this time, on the left, move 3 sts with the 3 prong tool onto empty needle to leave a hole.



- So in total (from left) you should be looking at;
Empty needle WP
3 Stitches
Empty needle NWP
6 Stitches (cable)
Empty needle NWP
3 Stitches fashioning.

So, that is how to knit a cable travelling at an angle that moves every two rows. Try moving the stitches every four rows or even every row and note the difference in the angles.



Try to knit cables that follow the contours of the body.



For some fashion inspiration, The House of Pringle has a history of traditional knitting (including amazing cables) but now brings this right up to date with modern yarns and silhouettes.



Cables with purl stitch.

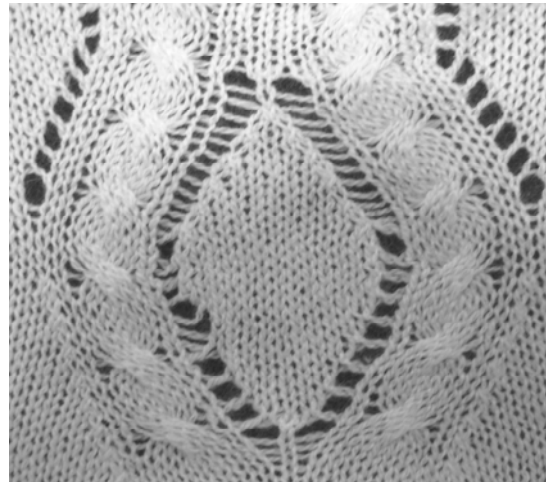


If you have been purling dropped stitches with your latch tool, you will have already practised this, so now incorporate it more into your patterns.

The purl st. helps cables stand out from the knit fabric and adds more stitch interest to the pattern.

For example in the photo right, the cables have travelled outwards then back inwards forming a diamond in the centre.

This photo below incorporates the purl stitch.



- Travel your cables outwards purl all the stitches that form the diamond in the centre with your latch tool.
- So purl every 2 rows when fashioning back closing the diamond.

This lambswool sample has been handwashed and tumble dried so the stitches close up and the cable is more prominent

Also instead of just purling up just one stitch at the side of your cable - vary the amount.



Plaits



- This is worked over a group of nine sts. So 3 groups of 3.
- Cross sts. 4,5,6, under 1,2,3,
- Knit 4 rows.
- Cross 4,5,6, under 7,8,9.
- Knit 4 rows.
- Repeat

Try other variations of this technique, try plaiting four groups (12st).



or knitting lots of 3st. plaits very close together ..



Combine plaits with other cable formations.



So, once you can move all your cables integrally, you can now try applique (sewing on top).



Applique Cables



This works well if you applique cables you could not knit integrally. So would have taken an impossibly long time to knit.



Simply knit only the cable and simply sew on top where you like, maybe curve it ?

Sew in the same yarn as your background and cable.

For a different look make your background completely contrasting to the cables.

Combine with pointelle /other backgrounds.

You can also use whatever size of cable you like.

Or use fabric (the same as base fabric or contrasting) to make a super giant cable.



Double Cables



You can make different patterns by experimenting with double cables;

You simply knit two 3st. cables side by side alternating the way you twist them

- So you have two groups of 6 sts.



- Number the stitches left to right 1,2,3,4,5,6,/4,5,6,1,2,3,
- Every time cross the 4,5,6, towards the front.
- Or cross 4,5,6 and 4,5,6.

In this example on the right, there are two 3st. cables running side by side that cross at 4 rows then 8 rows.

There are many more examples of cable stitches in specific knitting books.



Try Barbara Walker's Treasury of Knitting Patterns.





If you experiment with double cables as explained above you will also get 'medallions' like these examples.

Oxo cable.

- Worked over 8 sts.
- Cross sts. 3,4 under 1,2.
- Cross sts. 5,6, under 7,8,
- Knit 4 rows.
- Repeat.
- Knit 4 rows (so this will be 8 rows with no crossing)
- Cross 1,2 under 3,4,
- Cross 7,8 under 5,6. Knit 4 rows.
- Repeat.



These 20 rows you've knitted are the pattern.

Try all the different cables you've knitted on one sample.



Change Direction.



- Try knitting a sample with lots of simple cables. On the right is a plait with ladders.
- Cast off and re-hang on the machine by its selvedge.

- So now it's horizontal.
- Pull needles out to E position for the first row then continue to knit more cables vertically.



Use for a shoulder or a waist, doing this on the machine gives you a neat seam.

See if there is another way to change the direction of your cable.

Curve your cable and see where it works on the dress form.



Curve your cable



- Knit a cable, take it off the machine.
- Hang back on the machine horizontally.
- Gather the centre 20 stitches of the cable by hooking two stitches onto one needle
- How much you gather depends on how long your cable is and how much you want it to curve.
- Hang the surrounding stitches on one stitch per needle.

Short rows

On your carriage activate the holding cams by selecting H on a Brother machine and II on a Knitmaster.

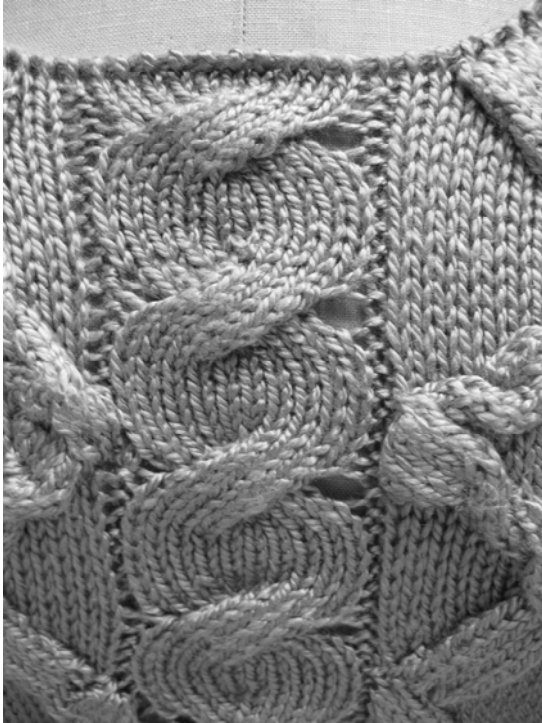
- Pull needles out to position E (HP) from the right selvedge
- Pull out 2 needles at a time and knit 2 rows.
- Continue to cable as you knit the extra rows.
- When all needles are in position E push them back into working position from the left selvedge 2 needles x 2 rows until they are all back in working position.
- Cable the stitches as you knit.



In the design above, pieces created with this technique have then been patchworked together to form a bodice.



Giant Cables.



- Work over a group of 12 sts.
- On the side opposite the carriage, pull all needles beyond the 12st. cable group out into HP.
- Knit 1 row.
- Pull all needles into HP except the 12st. cable.
- Knit 3 rows across these 12 st.
- Pull 6st opposite the carriage into HP.
- Knit 9 or any odd number of rows on these 6 st.
- Cross these with the 6st in HP, cross the 6 with the most rows towards the front of the fabric, the rest towards the back.

- Push all needles into position to knit.
- Knit 6 rows across all needles

Or for a flatter cable:

- Again work over 12 needles.
- Push all needles to the left of the cable to HP
- Knit 1 row.
- Push all needles to the right side of cable and 6 needles (of your 12) to HP
- Knit 5 rows on these 6st.
- Break your yarn.
- Pull these needles forward, push right hand 6 back to working position and knit 5 rows on those.
- Cross using 6 prong tools.
- Push all needles in position to knit, knit 6 rows across all needles.



- ❖ Combine with another technique; smaller cables or appliqué cables for example.





As you are knitting the cable independently of the main fabric you could;

- Change the yarn you cable with.
- Change the colour of the cable.

You could also knit sections separately using the holding cams, take the sections off the machine, cable elaborately and hook stitches back on the machine.

Make the individual sections to be cabled very long and able to stretch across lots of needles when crossed and knotted many times.

It gives an interesting very open fabric



Knit a sample like this and place on a dummy/dress form in a different direction to the way it's been knitted.



To make a flat fabric remember to knit the same number of rows back into the sections that aren't cabled.



...unless you want a cable that bulges out.



Experiment with cable direction and with extra rows.



Pointelle cable.

You can combine any stitch with a cable.



Here are cable stitches combined with pointelle (lace knitting)...

...and made of pointelle



Make your cable large enough so that you can clearly see the pointelle.



This example is a 12 st. cable made in the same way as the giant cables.



Using a cable in a seam.

Try different ways of joining two garment pieces together



Could a cable travel or run along a seam?

Here I've used my cable to join the sleeve to the bodice.



Knit two separate pieces maybe with pointelle or cable and pointelle at the edges.

Then knit three long strips of plain knit about 3-6 sts.wide and very long.

Use these to join your two separate samples together.

Cable them, knot them, lace them, plait them – again it looks amazing if you make something that would be very difficult to knit integrally.

Use this technique for edges, shoulder seams, necklines e.t.c.



Recreate the Title Page.



The design on the front page has been pieced together. It consists of 4x giant cables, 6x strips of knit and a stitch called faggotting holding it all together.

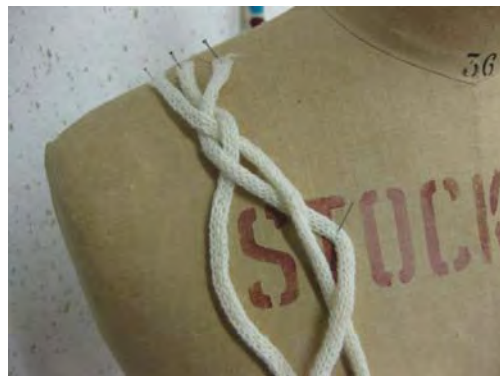
- Cast on 18 sts. This will be a cable of 12sts. With 3sts. either side. See page 11 for how to knit giant cables.
- Knit this 12st.cable with at least 14 cables in it.
- Knit this twice.
- Knit two more but with only x4 cables in them for the shorter collar pieces.
- Now cast on 6 sts. And knit for 1 metre.
- Knit 5 more so you have 6 strips in total.



- Take 3 for each side of the body, you will need a dress form or a surface you can pin your strips to, to hold them in place.

Plait or cable the strips into any design you like. This one is a simple plait but plaited tight and very loosely then pulled into position.

- Position your cables next to these freestanding cables how you want them- I curved the longer strips around the body. Pin in place.
- Now thread a darning needle with 2 ends of the same yarn you've used in the cables.





Faggotting.



- Take the needle behind this first loop, as you go up to the first strip to sew from back to front again.



- Again put needle behind this stitch, as in photos and repeat.



You can make this stitch as wide as you need it to be. So you can place your cables and strips wherever you like on the body and just faggot in the gaps.





Investigate the craft of **Macrame**.

It is a different way of knotting but looks very effective.

You can achieve a cabled effect and vertical stripes of colour.



❖ Like crochet, it is freer for changing direction than machine knit.



- ❖ Take a look at the modern macramé in Louise Goldin's work.
- ❖ Old craft books also have a wealth of ideas.



- ❖ For enormous sculptural cables see the work of designers such as Sandra Backlund, Alexander McQueen, Krizia and Giles.



So take the traditional, experiment and make it contemporary!

Glossary

E-wrap *cast on method for finished edge loop yarn around needles from left to right making the shape of a lower case e around each needle while needles are in E position.*

Sts *stitches(abbreviation)*

Prong tool *double ended tools that come with machine either have 1 and 2, 1 and 3, 2 and 3 prongs.*

Latch tool *tool that looks like a machine needle, used for picking up stitches.*

On the left side of the needle bed on machine

Needle position;

A *non working position/ needles will not knit*

B *working position / needles will knit*

D *selected for pattern knitting/ needles will knit*

E *holding position/ needles will knit unless holding cam is switched to H or II*

HP *holding position*

Holding cam *control on carriage on Brother machines N Or H on Knitmaster I or II. Select H and II for short row knitting, needles selected into position E will NOT knit.*

Swatch *piece of knitting/fabric*

Pointelle *lace knitting*

Eyelet *one stitch lace hole*

1x1 pointelle *1 row of 1 stitch lace holes*

Fashion / fashioning *moving multiple stitches*

Cast off *bind off*

Dress Form *dummy/ mannequin*



The business was set up in 1992 by Richard Dykes and Sue Enticknap and worked to become established as one of the top fashion textile design companies, selling to the industry at all levels of the market.

For nearly 20 years we have designed and made our copyrighted one-off creative designs. We have an extensive range of customers and hence we are constantly working with the fashion industry worldwide.

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